# Aiysha Varraich


Contact Information

✉ aiyshav@gmail.com


Academic Appointments

**Georgia Southern University** 2025 - present
*Lecturer*

**University of Nottingham and Global Integrity** 2020- 2023
*Research Associate in Anti-Corruption Evidence programme*

Career breaks

*Parental leave December 2017 - Februrary 2019*
*Parental leave May 2024 - June 2025*

Education

**University of Gothenburg**,*Ph.D. Political Science* 2024
Dissertation: *Clients of God - exploring how hierarchical religious bonds shape political behaviour*

**University of Georgia, Athens**, *Visiting Scholar* 2016
**University of Michigan**, *ICPSR Summer Program* 2015
**University of Gothenburg**, *MSc, Int'l Administration & Global Governance* 2011
**London Metropolitan University**, *LLB Law* 2007

Research Interests

Corruption, Political Behaviour, Religion and Politics, Gender, South Asia

Fieldwork

Pakistan, 2011, 2015, 2019 Hala, Karachi, Lahore, Multan, Islamabad
Sweden, 2010

Peer-reviewed Publications

**Articles**

Varraich, A., Köbis, N.C. and Lange, J. (2025), The Social Psychology of Corruption. Eur J Soc Psychol., 55: 419-423. https://doi.org/10.1002/ejsp.3165

**Books**

Varraich, Aiysha. (2024) *Clients of God - Exploring how hierarchical religious bonds shape political behaviour* Göteborg Politcal Studies 184, GUPEA

Kubbe, Ina and Aiysha Varraich. (2020). *Corruption and Informal Practices in the Middle East and North Africa* Routledge Corruption and Anti-Corruption Studies, UK, Routledge (equal contribution)

Rothstein, Bo and Aiysha Varraich. (2017). *Making Sense of Corruption* Cambridge, Cambridge University Press (equal contribution)

**Book Chapters**

Varraich, Aiysha (2025). "Making Sense of Corruption through interviews" in Johnston, M. (Ed.) *Handbook of Research Methods for Corruption Studies.* Edward Elgar Publishing. Forthcoming.

Varraich, Aiysha. (2022). "Are Clients of God anti-democratic?" In Widmalm, S. (Ed.) *Routledge Handbook on Autocratization in South Asia*

Varraich, Aiysha. (2017). "Making Sense of Corruption through interviews?" In Schwickerath, A. K., Varraich, A., Smith, L.-L. (Eds.). (2017). *How to research corruption? Conference Proceedings: Interdisciplinary Corruption Research Forum, June 2016.* Interdisciplinary Corruption Research Network. https://nbn-resolving.org/urn:nbn:de:0168-ssoar-52393-

**Policy Reports**

Varraich, Aiysha. (2019). "Data Portrait on Pakistan" Democracy, Human Rights and Governance Learning, Evaluation and Research. USAID.

Rothstein, Bo and Aiysha Varraich. (2014). "Corruption and the Opposite to Corruption A Map of the Conceptual Landscape", ANTICORRP, WP1, Deliverable for the European Commission Directorate.

Varraich, Aiysha. (2010). "Västra Götaland Region" in Charron, N., V. Lapuente and B. Rothstein (eds.) *Measuring the Quality of Government in the EU and Subnational Variation* Report for the European Commission Directorate-General, Regional Policy and Directorate Policy Development (with Sofia Jonsson)

## Working Papers

Jadoon Amira, Aiysha Varraich and Sibongile Majola (2024) Protesting with Abandon – Exploring the Drivers of Women's Protests in Pakistan (under review)

Pozsgai, Joseph and Aiysha Varraich. (2023).Are different types of corruption tolerated differently? *QoG Working Paper Series 2023:15*, Department of Political Science, University of Gothenburg.

Varraich, Aiysha. (2021). Religious clientelism - a theory *QoG Working Paper Series 2021:5* Department of Political Science, University of Gothenburg.

Varraich, Aiysha. (2019). What is Religious Clientelism and why should we care?

Varraich, Aiysha. (2014). Corruption: An Umbrella Concept *QoG Working Paper Series 2014:05* Department of Political Science, University of Gothenburg.

## Teaching

Georgia Southern University
Global Issues (Fall 2025)

University of Gothenburg

Political Institutions and actors (Spring 2015, Fall 2015, Spring 2016)
Political Theory and international politics (Fall 2014, Spring 2015)

Interdisciplinary Corruption Research Network's Forum, Amsterdam

Interviewing as a tool for researching corruption - qualitative interview methods (Summer 2016)

## Honors, Awards & Grants

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| European Consortium of Political Research, Co-PI, 2023 | €5000 |
| Ajuntament de Barcelona, Co-PI, 2023 | €10 000 |
| Quality of Government Institute, fieldwork grant, 2019 | €3600 |
| Riksbankens jubileumsfond, grant for research initiation, co-PI 2018 | €50 000 |
| Philosophical Faculties travel grant, 2017 | €2000 |
| Quality of Government Institute, travel grant, 2017 | €800 |
| Paul & Marie Berghaus Donations Fund 2016 | €1600 |
| Kungliga Hvitfeldtska Stipendiefonden 2016 | €2000 |
| Philosophical Faculties travel grant, 2015 | €1650 |
| Quality of Government Institute, fieldwork grant, 2015 | €4150 |
| Forum for South Asian Studies, Uppsala University, travel grant 2015 | €139 |
| Paul & Marie Berghaus Donations Fund 2015 | €1940 |
| Kungliga Hvitfeldtska Stipendiefonden 2015 | €1800 |
| Swedish International Development Agency, Internship grant, 2012 | €2500 |
| Swedish International Development Agency, Minor Field Study, 2011 | €2500 |

## Invited Talks

2025 Linnaeus University (November)
2022 International Youth Think Tank
2021 The Swedish Institute of International Affairs
2019 General Research Seminar, University of Gothenburg
2018 European University Institute
2018 Public Administration & Public Policy Seminar, University of Gothenburg
2017 Graduate seminar, University of Georgia, Athens
2017 Blavatnik School of Government, University of Oxford
2016 Interdisciplinary Corruption Research Network 1st Forum, Amsterdam
2014 The International Science Festival Gothenburg, Sweden
2011 North Atlantic Treaty Organisation, 6th Afghan Students Forum, Tallin

## Academic Conferences

2023 Interdisciplinary Corruption Research Network 7th Forum, Barcelona
2021 Interdisciplinary Corruption Research Networks 5th Forum, virtual
2021 Quality of Government Institute conference, virtual
2019 Pre-APSA South Asia Conference, World Bank, Washington DC
2019 Interdisciplinary Corruption Research Network Forum, Kyiv
2018 European Consortium for Political Research General Conference, Hamburg
2018 Interdisciplinary Corruption Research Network 3rd Forum, Gothenburg
2017 Quality of Government Institute conference, Budapest

2017 Interdisciplinary Corruption Research Network Forum, Paris
2016 Annual Conference on South Asia, University of Wisconsin-Madison
2016 Interdisciplinary Corruption Research Network Forum, Amsterdam
2016 Quality of Government Institute Conference, Nice
2015 Quality of Government and the Performance of Democracies conference
2015 Midwest Political Science Association Annual Conference, Chicago, IL
2015 Quality of Government Conference, Malaga
2014 ANTICORRP Consortium Meeting, Berlin
2014 Quality of Government Conference, Krakow
2013 ANTICORRP, Consortium Meeting, Berlin
2013 Quality of Government Conference, Gottskär
2013 ANTICORRP, Consortium Meeting, Florence

## Additional Academic Training

2020 Teaching and Learning in Higher Education HPE101
2017 3rd Leuven-Montréal Winter School on Elections and Voting Behavior
2016 Political Strategy: An Introduction to Rational Choice Theory
2015 Experimental design and analysis

## Service

**Departmental service**
Graduate Studies Council Cashier (09/2014- 06/2016 )
Work environment ombudsman for Research Associates (01/2013- 06/2014 )
**Reviewer for**
*American Political Science Review, European Journal of International Security, Political Research Quarterly, Comparative Political Studies, Crime, Law and Social Change, Organizational Behavior and Human Decision Processes, American Behavioral Scientist*
**Guest Editor**
*European Journal of Social Psychology - special issue - Social Psychology of Corruption*

**Conferences organised** *Lead organiser*
2023 7th Interdisciplinary Corruption Research Forum, Barcelona, Spain
2021 5th Interdisciplinary Corruption Research Forum, virtual (due to pandemic)
2018 3rd Interdisciplinary Corruption Research Forum, Gothenburg, Sweden

## Skills

**Languages** Native speaker in English, Swedish, and Urdu. Punjabi (proficient), Hindi (spoken) **Software** LaTeX, Microsoft Office, STATA, QGIS (beginner), NViVO, Atlas.ti and familiarity with R

## Other Professional Experience

**Quality of Government Institute**, *Research Associate* 2012 - 2014
Mapping the different conceptualisations of corruption as part of European Union

funded ANTICORRP project

**American Bar Association**, Washington DC *Legal Research Associate* 2012
Conducted in-depth research as requested by UNDP country offices, analysing existing legal frameworks, drafting reports and reviewing UNDP requests for legal experts

**Quality of Government Institute**, *Graduate Research Assistant* 2009 - 2010
Developed and drafted literature review on quality of government and its intersection with social sciences and policy development for the primary deliverable to the EU Commission. Managed 8 research assistants, planned all critical activities to ensure completion within given timeframe. Delivered refresher courses on interview techniques. Designed main interview guide in collaboration with research team. Conducted qualitative interviews with local experts from the educational, health and media sectors. Proof reading and editing of drafts and final report including first-stage editing of all ten case studies of EU NUTS regions

**IA Solicitors, London UK** , *Legal trainee* 2006 - 2008
Managed high profile commercial and residential property portfolios. Notable achievements: successful completion of commercial leases for multi- million pound nursing home and eight re-mortgages valued at eight million pounds. Ensured legal compliance. Worked closely with clients to build strong relationships with effective stakeholder management on a daily basis, maintained close relations with key contacts at banks for effective account management, established strong credibility with lenders to provide assurance regarding client's credentials as a borrower and developed a cooperative relationship with the Land Registry to conduct legal searches